

**T**he game industry today seeks individuals with focused specific skills and expertise though multi-skilled people always have a place. Every job in this industry requires you to have a passion for games. You should play games, the ones you like, the ones you hate and all the others in between. Passion and love for games is inarguably necessary. And then there are a list of other skills that fall under the “must have” and “should have” categories. If you understand what a job demands from you, you can prepare for that job from the start.

Often folks are confused game designers’ job profiles with that of level designers’, or designers’ with artists’. In order to clear up all the confusion, we’ll take a look at all the roles in an organisation. We’ll delve into each role in detail for you, so that you also get a clear idea of the kind of job you would be more suited / qualified for, and thus be more focused with your applications to such companies. All jobs in game industry are basically divided into a few paths that you can specialise in:

- ▶ **Design:** This includes Game Designers, Level Designers, UI Designers, Systems Designers and at higher levels, also includes the Game Director, Creative Director, etc.
- ▶ **Programming:** This includes programmers skilled in the art of game programming, AI, graphics, networking and more
- ▶ **Game art and animation:** 2D/3D Animators, Concept Artists, UI Artists
- ▶ **Production:** Producers and Executive Producers
- ▶ **Quality Assurance:** Quality Testers and Software Engineers
- ▶ **Audio:** Audio often makes a game, and audio artists are essential to the process. Some talented souls here.

In this chapter, we’ll look at each of these six varying roles in much greater detail to help you plan your way.

## Design

Game development requires a lot of creative processes to happen and thus needs design expertise. Designers include Game Designers, Level Designers, UI Designers, Systems Designers, etc. Higher level positions include Game Directors, Creative Directors, etc.

### Game Designers

*“Working as a game designer is like the mouse on your computer; some days it clicks and some days it drags.”*

- Alan Emrich, Game Designer